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Department of Computer Science and Engineering
Program: Bachelor of Science in Computer Science and Engineering

Project Proposal

Course No: CSE-1200

Course Title: Software Development – I

Project Title : Prince of Persia- Escape from the Palace

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Submitted to

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Project Shadow-Flame

Executive Game Development Proposal (3-Page Framework)

Target Platforms: PC, MacOS, Nintendo Switch, PlayStation 5, Xbox Series X/S

Timeline: 6 Months

Genre: 2D Cinematic Action-Platformer / Metroidvania

Engine: Unity (URP 2.5D)

1. Objectives

Project Shadow-Flame outlines a streamlined commercial framework to remake the 1993 cinematic platformer classic, re-envisioned under the title **Prince of Persia- Escape from the Palace**. The objective is to retain the signature momentum-driven side-scrolling geometry and atmospheric Middle Eastern narrative of Jordan Mechner's original mechanical foundation, while introducing modern 2.5D rendering pipeline assets and responsive combat layouts. This short-form proposal acts as an operational brief for publishing partners and engineering leads.

2. Target Audience & Market Positioning

To maximize commercial viability across the 6-month delivery window, the product targets three distinct player demographics:

Modern Metroidvania & The Retro Purists (Ages 14+):

- Players of modern side-scrolling titles like Prince of Persia: The Lost Crown, Hollow Knight, and Dead Cells. They expect fluid, responsive combat frameworks, precise movement controls, and intricate environmental puzzle-solving.
- For long-time fans of the original 1989 and 1993 Jordan Mechner classics, as well as enthusiasts of early cinematic platformers. This segment demands faithful mechanical momentum, high-stakes navigation, and traditional lore preservation.

3. Core Gameplay Pillars

To preserve the identity of the original title while satisfying modern side-scrolling design standards, the product focuses strictly on three mechanics:

- Weight-Based Platforming:** Traversal prioritizes physical momentum, deliberate jump calculations, and ledge navigation. High-framerate 3D skeletons are constrained to a 2D plane to simulate the fluid feel of classic rotoscoping.

- **Astral Shadow Projection:** A core mechanical puzzle layer. The player can temporarily release their astral "Shadow" form to bypass active blade traps or manipulate remote switches, leaving the physical King stationary and vulnerable.
- **Multi-Directional Crowd Combat:** One must either attempt to face enemies one by one, or manage attacks coming from a single or both directions in side-scrolling combat.

4. Narrative Focus & Biome Scope

- **The Persian Palace Tops:** Vertical rooftop navigation under active pursuit layers.
 - **Desert Islands & Caverns:** Dense beachside shipwreck debris shifting into subterranean puzzle passages.
 - **The Ancient Ruined Temple:** Heavy puzzle-oriented environments populated by skeletal guardians.
- The Shadow Realm: An ethereal, surreal environment demanding full synergy of the projection mechanics.

5. Schedule, Milestones & Timeline

Phase	Major Focus	Core Milestones
Months 1 – 2	Prototyping & Physics Calibration	Graybox completion of Level 1. Optimization of jumping physics, horizontal momentum, and the basic movement scheme.
Months 3– 4	Vertical Slice Production	Artistic completion of the "Desert Island" assets. Production-ready implementation of the core astral mechanics. Internal demo build.
Months 5 – 6	Beta Optimization & Submission	Frame-rate tuning for targeted consoles, multi-language localization passes, QA testing, and submission to platform holders.

6. Risk Matrix & Quality Mitigation

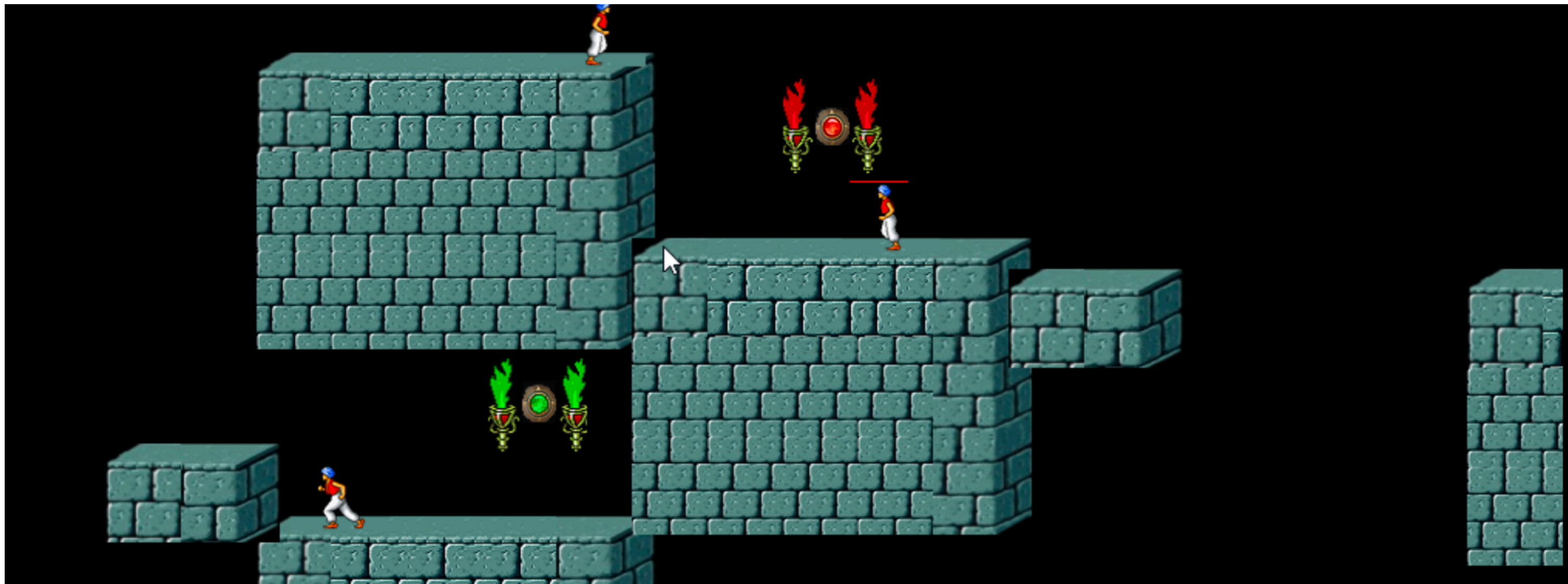
Risk A: Balancing Retro Difficulty. The 1993 mechanics were highly punitive, presenting potential frustration barriers for modern casual players.

Mitigation: To address challenges, there will be checkpoints and guides, while experienced players can opt for a completely unassisted 'Retro Mode'.

Risk B: Level Design Scope Creep. Over-expanding map size can break the tight 6-month production loop.

Mitigation: Retain strict 1:1 structural blueprint parity with the classic geometry for critical paths, concentrating environmental additions entirely on deep visual assets, lighting layers, and background set dressing.

Interface of reference game:



Inspiration

Inspired by Prince of Persia 2: The Shadow and the Flame Longplay

<https://youtu.be/dhwU33IPmVQ?si=2EsTTy6KVYPoOyNZ>



Conclusion

Prince of Persia- Escape from the Palace revives the strict, nostalgic platforming of the 1993 classic within a modern, ultra-responsive 2.5D visual framework. By targeting both legacy purists and modern Metroidvania players, the project delivers a commercially viable experience optimized for a 6-months production loop.